The mandate test.

Pick one specific use case (recruiting, customer support, maintenance, finance…). The test measures not so much how autonomous your AI is as the gap between what the AI does and what your organization has built around it. Score each line from 0 to 2.

Use case assessed: _____

What the AI does — delegation D, out of 6

	0	1	2	SCORE
Trigger	Waits for a human request	Fires on an event	Acts continuously	
Scope	Produces a response	Chains a sequence of tasks	Makes a binding decision	
Access to systems	Outside the enterprise's systems	Reads the systems	Writes to the systems	

What the organization has built around it — control M, out of 8

	0	1	2	SCORE
Verifiability	The result can only be checked by judgment	Verified by sampling	Verified by a rule or a test, every time	
Reversibility	An error reaches a customer, a judge, a regulator	Repairable, at a cost	Caught before any effect	
Accountability	Nobody answers for the agent	A project manager	A named owner, with the right to stop it	
Dividend	The time saved has no destination	It is measured	It is allocated and tracked	

Delegation D: ___ / 6 Control M: ___ / 8

The verdict

The verdict is not a sum. You read it by plotting D (responds 0–2, chains 3–4, decides 5–6) against M (exposed 0–3, framed 4–5, controlled 6–8). One line, however, cannot be offset by the others: without a named person who answers for the agent (a zero on the Accountability line), M is capped at "exposed," regardless of the other scores.

	M — EXPOSED	M — FRAMED	M — CONTROLLED
D — responds	Equipped: an assistant, nothing to govern yet	Calibrated, but timid	Under-delegated: you are leaving value on the table—this case could decide
D — chains	Fragile: a chain nobody owns	Calibrated	Ready to move up a notch
D — decides	Over-delegated: the alienated enterprise, in miniature	Watch closely: the mandate outruns the verification	Calibrated: agentic AI as this book understands it

Rule — Accountability is the precondition for every other criterion.